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THE EL PASO TIMES

Cellar Battle Starts Friday

If the University of Texas at El Paso baseball team needed incentive for the final 1974 series Friday and Saturday at Dudley Field, it's to decide which WAC team ends up in the conference cellar.

They host New Mexico noon Friday and 10 a.m., Saturday in a doubleheader.

And the Lobos have only a one-game edge in the loop —3-12 to 2-13—and it's the final three-games of the year, so the Miners have nothing but to go-for-broke.

It will also be yea or nay for both teams as far as having a winning season. The Miners are 24-24, the Lobos 22-23.

Add to this the fact Coach Andy Cohen's hopefuls only need two victories to equal the all-time school win skein of 26, and you have all the makings of a super finish.

"The team is really up in spirit this week," Coach Cohen said at Hugo Meyer practice. "Everyone is healthy and we're really going out for this one and a decent finish for the season."

In their last outing in Albuquerque, the Lobos took three off the Miners, 6-2, 3-2, 9-4. Coach Cohen blamed that one on they're (Lobos) playing really well, and his Miners not hitting up to par.

"I'm happy to see Husting Herbie (Von Hagen) hitting well in practice," Cohen said. "He's been in a batting slump lately and it looks like he'll come out of it." Von Hagen has dipped from .375 to .302 in the stats.

Cohen said he'll start with Roy Stringer (6-4) and hold Jeff Hogan (3-5) and Dan Modlinski (3-4) in reserve.

Lobo Coach Bob Leigh will counter with Kent Seaman (3-6), Ron Adair (4-4) and Doug Johnson (4-3).

Right fielder Mike Pettenuzzo heads the Lobo hitters with .362 followed by Bill Piskorski, left field at .331 and Adair, first baseman and pitcher at .302.

For the Miners, Glenn Villarreal at third base is the top hitter with a .379 clip (nine Doubles), center fielder Joe Pennies is second with .336 (also nine doubles) paced by four home runs with Mark Miller next at .332 (six homers).

Other Miner batsmen above .300 are Jim Brundage, catcher, .330, Terry Dillingham at .320, Bob Downing with .315 and Von Hagen's .302.